

TABLE II
ADMISSIONS AND OUTCOME PARAMETERS.

	γ^{admit}	UTA GPA	LPM UTA Persist	LPM UTA STEM	TAMU GPA	LPM TAMU Persist	LPM TAMU STEM
Constant	0.0 (0.0)	2.611 (0.077)	0.941 (0.064)	-0.27 (0.043)	2.606 (0.105)	1.013 (0.052)	-0.295 (0.069)
SAT	5.624 (0.929)	4.737 (0.381)	0.188 (0.577)	0.229 (0.024)	3.724 (0.703)	0.129 (0.024)	0.399 (0.256)
Class Rank	-2.435 (0.193)	-0.781 (0.299)	-0.445 (0.133)	-0.242 (0.167)	-0.356 (0.295)	-0.458 (0.205)	-0.274 (0.194)
SAT Ratio	-1.2 (0.477)	-2.692 (0.255)	-0.104 (0.384)	0.266 (0.031)	-2.122 (0.444)	-0.09 (0.04)	0.384 (0.166)
Poverty	0.278 (0.239)	-0.235 (0.074)	-0.241 (0.105)	-0.163 (0.032)	-0.278 (0.137)	-0.232 (0.036)	-0.32 (0.068)
URM	0.011 (0.073)	0.055 (0.029)	0.008 (0.016)	0.055 (0.014)	-0.006 (0.032)	0.001 (0.014)	0.082 (0.019)
Scholarship	0.0 (0.0)	0.193 (0.043)	0.086 (0.026)	0.022 (0.029)	0.093 (0.12)	0.01 (0.078)	0.215 (0.089)
Caliber (q)	1.0 (0.0)	-0.988 (0.304)	-0.002 (0.094)	0.152 (0.135)	-1.018 (0.26)	-0.1 (0.158)	-0.118 (0.158)

Note: This table shows admissions-index parameters γ^{admit} (Equation (3)) and outcome indices (Equation (6)). Standard errors are shown in parentheses. By assumption the elements of γ^{admit} multiplying Scholarship (LOS for UT-Austin, CS for Texas A&M) and caliber are zero and one, respectively.

ably well, but then underpredicts low-class-rank students’ STEM participation. For transparency, this figure does not control for other covariates.

6.2. Selected Estimates

Table II presents admissions and outcome parameters. I estimate linear models for GPA, and for persistence and STEM indicators, which I use for counterfactuals. Admission chances are higher for students with high SAT scores (normalized to a 0-1 scale) and top class rank (the top decile has rank =.1). Admissions offices prefer students from high-poverty schools but penalize students from schools with low SAT scores, as indicated by the coefficient on “SAT ratio.” Weights on URM status are close to zero. Coefficients on scholarship availability and caliber are 0 and 1 by construction.

Turning to outcomes, SAT scores and class rank have the expected signs as well, but SAT ratio predicts majoring in STEM and is not significantly associated with lower persistence. “Caliber,” as valued by admissions offices, predicts lower GPA and has smaller or zero effects on other outcomes. The availability of the Longhorn Opportunity Scholars program raises GPA and persistence for students from participating high schools who attend UT Austin, consistent with [Andrews, Imberman, and Lovenheim \(2020\)](#).

In Appendix Table III, I present probit specifications for binary outcomes. In Supplemental Appendix E.7, I present estimates from an extension in which students’ preferences, as well as their caliber, may correlate with potential outcomes.

Figure 2 describes information, application costs, and admission chances. Panels A and B of figure plot standard deviations of signals (panel A) and means and standard deviations of costs (panel B) as functions of high school poverty rates. Panel A indicates that applicants face larger uncertainty in caliber q , conditional on their signal s , if they come